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UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED, MELONI DISCUSS REGIONAL DEVELOPMENTS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan met Giorgia Meloni, Prime Minister of Italy, yesterday. The leaders discussed the latest regional developments and their serious implications for security and stability, as well as their impact on maritime security, energy supplies, and the global economy. They also discussed the continued Iranian terrorist aggression targeting the UAE and other countries in the region, noting that it constitutes a violation of sovereignty, international law, and the UN Charter. Meloni reiterated Italy's condemnation of the terrorist attacks and affirmed her country's solidarity with the UAE regarding the measures being taken to safeguard its security and sovereignty and ensure the safety of its territory and people.

SEE ALSO P12-13

Dubai reroutes cargo via Oman

Initiative builds on
Dubai-Oman
green corridor

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE

Your Money Editor

A new customs directive has formalised how cargo will move between Dubai and global markets through Oman, expanding on the green corridor initiative announced in March.

The customs notice, issued on Saturday, outlines a temporary framework to reroute shipments via land through Oman's

ports and airports, as authorities respond to disruptions affecting sea and air connectivity across the GCC.

"During the current disruption to sea and air routes, a temporary facilitation is hereby introduced permitting movement of cargo from Dubai to Rest of the World (RoW) via the Green Corridor at Hatta and the land routes of the Sultanate of Oman," the notice said.

"In order to ensure continuity of supply chains and facilitate trade movement ... this has been decided with the agreement of the Directorate General of Customs of Oman."

The move builds on the ear-

lier Dubai-Oman green corridor activation, shifting from a policy announcement to a more detailed operational system covering both sea and air cargo.

The directive reflects ongoing logistics constraints, with disruptions to maritime and air routes affecting regional trade flows and prompting a focus on maintaining supply chain continuity.

Under the framework, cargo originating in Dubai — or arriving from overseas — can be transported via bonded trucks through the Hatta border crossing and routed onward through Oman's ports and airports.

SEE ALSO P8

TRUMP THREATENS 'POWER PLANT DAY' STRIKES ON IRAN

Tehran seeks war compensation to reopen Hormuz

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump yesterday threatened to strike Iran's power plants and bridges in an expletive-laden warning if Tehran does not reopen the vital Strait of Hormuz, even as he announced the rescue of a "seriously wounded" American airman in what he called a "miraculous" operation.

Posting on *Truth Social*, Trump said the airman had been rescued "from deep inside the mountains of Iran" in "one of the most daring search and rescue operations in US history." But he coupled the announcement with a stark ultimatum to Iran over disruptions to shipping through Hormuz.

"Tuesday will be Power Plant Day, and Bridge Day, all wrapped up in one, in Iran. There will be nothing like it!!!" he declared.

More optimistic tone

Despite the threat, Trump later struck a more optimistic tone, telling Fox News there was a "good chance" Iran could agree to a deal as early as today. His remarks came as Omani and Iranian deputy foreign ministers reportedly held talks aimed at easing passage through the strategic waterway.

An aide to Iran's president, Mahdi Tabatabaei, said the Strait of Hormuz "will be reopened" only if a portion of transit tolls is

GARGASH: EMBASSY ATTACKS VIOLATE LAW

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has said that attacks on embassies and diplomatic missions constitute a serious violation of international law and reflect shortcomings in the security environment of the countries where such incidents occur.

In remarks following the targeting of the UAE diplomatic mission in Damascus, Gargash said the actions of a small extremist group pursuing a rejected agenda came despite the fact that the UAE hosts a large Syrian community that lives and works in safety and stability. "These are dangerous messages that require a clear response and full commitment to respecting international law," he said.

Gargash yesterday also paid rich tribute to Bahrain's resilience and unity in the face of what he described as blatant Iranian aggression, underscoring GCC's solidarity at a time of heightened regional tensions. On Friday, Gargash criticised arguments put forward by former Iranian foreign minister Mohammad Javad Zarif in a recent article published in the US magazine *Foreign Affairs*, saying they overlook fundamental facts and Iran's continued hostile behaviour towards neighbouring countries.

— Gulf News Report

used to compensate for damage caused by the war.

The warning followed another day of escalating regional tensions, with critical infrastructure across the Gulf coming under attack.

In the UAE, authorities in Abu Dhabi said three fires broke out at the Borouge petrochemicals plant after debris fell following successful air defence interceptions. The Ministry of Defence said it engaged nine ballistic missiles, one cruise missile and 50 drones launched from Iran. Sharjah authorities responded to an attack targeting Khor Fakkan port, with no casualties.

Kuwait Petroleum Corporation said drone strikes hit multiple operational sites, including facilities of the Kuwait National Petroleum Company

and Petrochemical Industries Company, causing fires and significant material damage but no injuries.

Additional strikes

In Bahrain and elsewhere in the region, additional strikes were reported, underscoring the widening scope of the conflict.

In Iran, a strike near the Bush-eir nuclear plant on Saturday killed a guard, prompting Russia — which helped build and operate the facility — to evacuate 198 workers and condemn the attack as "an evil deed."

Saudi Arabia, meanwhile, condemned attacks on the UAE embassy and the residence of its head of mission in Damascus, calling them unacceptable violations.

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SPORT

A tale of two
Sameers: Rizvi
and Minhas are
lighting up IPL
and PSL | P15



WORLD

Lunar flyby:
Artemis II
astronauts
spot 'Grand
Canyon' | P11

UAE retains Aa2 credit rating with stable outlook

Moody's cites strong
finances, economic
diversification

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The Ministry of Finance announced that the credit rating agency Moody's Ratings (Moody's) has completed a periodic review of the ratings of the UAE on March 30.

The review reassessed the appropriateness of the current rating, which remains unchanged at Aa2 with a stable outlook, reflecting continued global confidence in the strength of the UAE's economy and the sustainability of its fiscal policies, despite ongoing regional geopolitical tensions.

UAE's creditworthiness

The review highlighted several key strengths underpinning the UAE's creditworthiness, including high per capita income, robust institutional frameworks, and effective policymaking that supports continued economic diversification and competitiveness.

Mohamed Bin Hadi Al Husaini, Minister of State for Financial Affairs, said that the

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completion of Moody's periodic review, with no change to the current rating and a stable outlook, reflects the UAE's strong institutional framework and its track record of effective governance and policymaking.

The Minister noted that the UAE's fiscal strength is anchored in the federal government's very low debt burden and its consistent track record of maintaining balanced budgets, reinforcing its resilience amid regional and global challenges.

He added that the stable outlook confirms that the UAE's sovereign credit profile remains robust, supported by substantial fiscal buffers and prudent financial management.

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